ALEK ORTIZ

Software Engineer

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SUMMARY

Software engineer with over five years of experience in building and modernizing production applications in TypeScript, across React and Svelte. Designs abstractions other teams adopt and is biased toward reducing system complexity over adding frameworks. Trusted with release safety, production incidents, and delivery leadership.

EXPERIENCE

Optimum Remote | May 2022 to Present

Software Development Engineer I

- **Designed a configuration-driven service request architecture** that ships new service flows through configuration rather than new implementations, pairing filesystem symlinks with TypeScript type safety instead of a micro-frontend; adopted by other teams as a standard integration pattern, with seven service request types running on it and 19 other developers building on it.
- **Led frontend delivery enabling mobile sales on the company's internal, agent-facing platform**, contributed to 35% YoY mobile sales growth, the strongest mobile year on company record.
- **Led team delivery for three months in the dev manager's absence**, running sprint planning, refinement, and standups across Dev and QA and merging 65 of the team's 91 UI pull requests; cut the backlog 60% and met key product milestones.
- **Designed and implemented centralized role-based access control** across client and server validation, introducing an app-wide redirect pattern and permission-aware form components extensible to new protected routes without rework.
- **Proposed and delivered the team's first AI-assisted developer tooling under manager sponsorship**, shipped in three weeks: a Jira-integrated PR-review automation encoding the codebase's correctness, security, accessibility, and testing checks, used across 100+ personal review sessions over four months; established the repository structure and conventions that 12 subsequent tooling tickets from five engineers built on.
- **Integrated generative AI (Gemini) into a change-of-service flow**, producing plain-language summaries of what changed in a customer's cart so agents can clearly explain new monthly charges at point of sale.
- **Enabled sales KPI reporting for the data team**: assessed about 33 requested data points against the codebase, ran the working session that settled six fields, and shipped them as GA4 events feeding BigQuery reporting, holding a customer-account field until a written PII exception was on record.
- **Own frontend release safety**, gating releases behind feature flags, setting up Google Cloud Monitoring for the app, and watching Beta and Prod logs through rollout; relied on to fix production issues, with 21 hotfixes shipped across 17 releases since June 2026.
- **Diagnosed a failed production hotfix deploy**, confirming production was still serving the prior build, tracing the failure to deploy configuration rather than application code, and giving the platform team remediation and prevention steps; restored the hotfix line the same day.
- **Introduced the team's Playwright UI testing practice** unprompted, recruiting other engineers and contributing to its documentation; kept the suite alive through a vendor transition by ruling out VM workarounds on developer-experience grounds and migrating the framework to Podman, then rebuilt it in 2026 as a mocked suite running in the merge-request pipeline.
- **Eliminated a requirement that frontend engineers run the full backend locally**, introducing a configuration that runs it against the deployed backend and cutting onboarding time and resource overhead across the team.
- **Cut dev-server warm starts from 8.95s to 3.52s (about 2.5x)**, tracing repeated dependency bundling and mid-session reloads to a shared Vite cache and optimizer globs that matched nothing.
- **Led a dependency migration** cutting known vulnerability warnings from about 50 to fewer than 10, restoring CI reliability and clearing the path to a Svelte 5 upgrade.
- **Planned a phased Svelte 5 migration and landed the cutover**, upgrading Svelte, the component library, and Vite across 169 files and patching every critical- and high-severity vulnerability; the remaining modernization continues by phase.

- **Led the refactor bringing the company's internal, agent-facing platform from desktop-only support to full iPad support** in one sprint with no wireframes, extending it to door-to-door sales agents for the first time; deployed and fully usable for submitting customer orders within days of launch.
- **Authored the frontend development guidelines, order entry architecture, and API documentation** a partner team relied on to build a public-facing sales application and serve as their ongoing technical reference.
- **Prevent technical debt at code-review time**, favoring live design discussions over inline comments; authors changed their code for 66 of 78 review comments since mid-2026, including on three leads' merge requests, and steered a teammate away from a state-management approach that would have caused scalability problems.
- **Advise on frontend architecture decisions across the team**, from library and framework selection to when to server-render and where to enforce type safety; the engineer peers bring architectural questions to before they commit.
- **Wrote the Svelte-versus-React migration analysis for leadership**, covering cost, risk, and a codebase inventory, with an executive summary for engineering, product, and business stakeholders; recommended staying on Svelte and reserving React for greenfield products.
- **Onboarded an incoming engineering team and mentor junior engineers 1:1** through daily collaboration; the named go-to expert across multiple core product areas.
- **Conduct interviews for lead software engineering candidates**, plus engineering and QA roles (24+ candidates since 2024), assessing technical and management competency against a structured question set and scoring rubric for fair evaluation.

Software Engineering Applications Remote | Dec 2020 to Jul 2021

Full-Stack Software Engineer, Part-time

- Built a React and Node.js/Express product-photos microservice (MongoDB, MERN stack) with a REST API and a shared styled-components design system, containerized with Docker and deployed through a CircleCI pipeline; automated test coverage with Jest and Enzyme to catch regressions during iterative deployment.
- Designed and built a horizontally scalable backend system (Node.js, CouchDB, Redis caching, NGINX micro-caching) to sustain high read volume under cost constraints; load-tested with New Relic, Loader.io, and K6, cutting average latency from ~2,400ms to ~27ms while scaling throughput to ~3.4k requests/second, deployed as containerized services to AWS EC2 through a CI/CD pipeline.

Accenture Austin, TX | Aug 2019 to Apr 2022

Provider Enrollment Specialist

- Ran end-to-end and scenario-based testing on a statewide provider enrollment platform, surfacing frontend defects.
- Worked directly with clients on the Vendor Drug Program rollout, helping ensure compliance with state contract requirements and smooth system adoption.

TECHNICAL SKILLS

Languages TypeScript, JavaScript (ES6+), HTML5, CSS3, Sass, SQL, NoSQL

Frameworks React, Next.js, Svelte, SvelteKit, Vue, Node.js, Express, Redux, styled-components

Databases & Caching MongoDB, CouchDB, Redis, NGINX

Testing & Tooling Playwright, Vitest, Jest, Enzyme, K6, New Relic, Loader.io, Git, Vite, Webpack, Docker, Podman, CircleCI, GraphQL, REST, AWS, GCP, Firebase, Cursor, Copilot, Claude Code

Practices TypeScript-first architecture, design systems, feature flagging, CI/CD, accessibility (WCAG, ARIA), performance optimization, AI-assisted development

EDUCATION

Hack Reactor — Advanced Software Engineering Immersive 2021

Austin Community College — A.S., Business Administration | Honors Program Member 2019